

ANTH 220: Cultural Anthropology and Ethnographic Fieldwork

Term: Fall 2026 | Instructor: Prof. Margaret Mead (mmead@anthro.univ.edu)

Course Description & Overview:

Ethnographic investigation of kinship structures, gift exchange economies, ritual symbolism, and postcolonial globalization.

COURSE ASSIGNMENTS & WEIGHT DISTRIBUTION

Assignment Description	Weight	Due Module	Deliverable Format
Participant Observation Fieldwork Note	25%	Week 04	Field Journal & Reflection
Kinship System Structural Analysis	25%	Week 07	Genealogical Diagram & Paper
Ethnographic Research Monograph	35%	Week 11	Fieldwork Research Paper
Seminar Discussion Leadership	15%	Continuous	Discussion Facilitation

WEEKLY TERM SCHEDULE & READING REQUIREMENTS

Timeline	Technical Topic Focus	Assigned Readings & Docs
Week 01	Module 01: Concept of Culture & Ethnography	Geertz (Ch. 1); Malinowski (Ch. 1)
Week 02	Module 02: Fieldwork Ethics & Reflexivity	Emerson et al. (Ch. 1–3)
Week 03	Module 03: Kinship, Marriage, and Descent	Fox (Ch. 2 & 3)
Week 04	Module 04: Economic Anthropology & Gift Exchange	Mauss (1925); Sahlins (Ch. 1)
Week 05	Module 05: Political Systems, Power, and Hegemony	Wolf (Ch. 4); Scott (1985)
Week 06	Module 06: Religion, Ritual, and Symbolism	Turner (Ch. 3); Evans-Pritchard (Ch. 2)
Week 07	Module 07: Language and Linguistic Relativity	Sapir (1929); Whorf (1956)
Week 08	Module 08: Gender, Sexuality, and Performance	Butler (1990); Mead (1928)
Week 09	Module 09: Globalization and Transnationalism	Appadurai (Ch. 2)
Week 10	Module 10: Medical Anthropology & Health Equity	Farmer (2003); Kleinman (Ch. 1)
Week 11	Module 11: Final Monograph Defense & Review	Ethnographic Retrospective